



Cambodia



East Timor



Indonesia



Laos



Malaysia



Palau



Philippines



Singapore



Thailand



Vietnam



Floating market

Much of Bangkok in Thailand is below sea level, and the city has a busy network of canals. Floating markets are colorful occasions—local traders bring their goods to market by boat, and shoppers paddle up to take a look at what is on display.

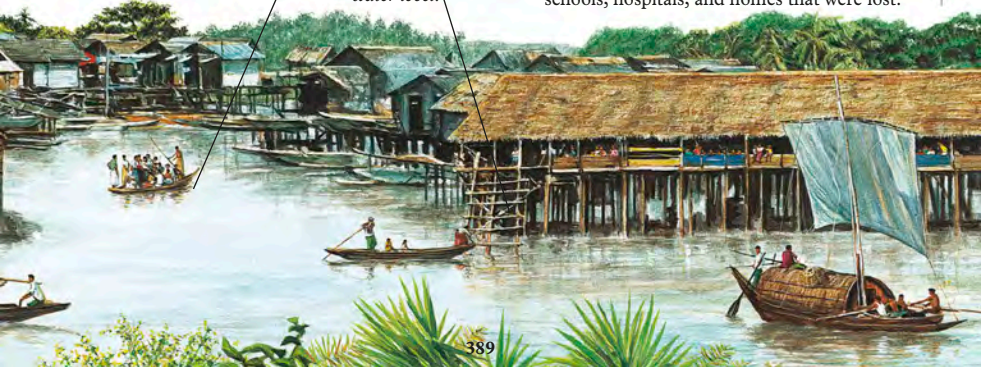


Religious teaching

The vast majority of Thais are Buddhists. Every male Buddhist is expected to become a monk for a while, to study religious teachings and prepare for adult life.

Boats are the main form of transportation. Rivers provide links between small communities.

Notched tree trunks or ladders are used to get down to the water level.



Bali dancers

The Indonesian island of Bali is famous for its exciting dances. Historical tales of local princes and heroes are acted out in a masked dance called the Wayang Topeng. The dance is very entertaining, with lots of clowning around as well as serious storytelling.

A Topeng dancer acts out the character of the mask.

Every movement is carefully controlled.



Extreme weather

In 2004, an earthquake caused a tsunami in Southeast Asia. With waves 100 feet (30 meters) high, entire towns, villages, and cropland were destroyed across 14 countries. Communities have pulled together to rebuild the many schools, hospitals, and homes that were lost.